b) *Our gates were strong, our walls were thick,*
So smooth and high, no man could win.

i. How safe was the castle?

ii. What was the firm belief of the soldiers?

c) *A foothold there, no clever trick*
Could take us dead or quick,
Only a bird could have got in.

i. What was challenging?

ii. Which aspect of the castle's strength is conveyed by the above line?

d) *Oh then our maze of tunneled stone*
Grew thin and treacherous as air.
The castle was lost without a groan,
The famous citadel overthrown,

i. Bring out the contrast in the first two lines.

ii. What is the rhyme scheme of the given stanza?

e) *We could do nothing, being sold.*

i. Why couldn't they do anything?

ii. Why did they feel helpless?

5. Explain the following with reference to the context in about 20-30 words each.

a) *Our gates were strong, our walls were thick,*

b) *Our captain was brave and we were true…*

c) *They seemed no threat to us at all.*

d) *How can this shameful tale be told?*

e) *I will maintain until my death*

f) *Our only enemy was gold*

6. Read the poem and complete the table with suitable rhyming words.

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7. Underline the alliterated words in the following lines.

a) *With our arms and provender, load on load.*

b) *A little wicked wicket gate.*

c) *The wizened warder let them through.*

8. Identify the figure of speech used in the following lines.

a) *A little wicked wicket gate.*

b) *Oh then our maze of tunneled stone*

c) *Grew thin and treacherous as air.*

d) *How can this shameful tale be told?*

e) *Our only enemy was gold,*

Allegory: An allegory is a complete narrative that involves characters and events that stand for an abstract idea or event. In other words, a story, poem, or picture that can be interpreted to reveal a hidden meaning, typically a moral or political one.

9. Can you call 'The Castle' an allegorical poem? Discuss.

Listening

Some phrases have been left out in the poem below. Fill in the missing phrases on listening to the reading or the audio played by the teacher. You may listen again, if required.

The Soldier

If I should die, ...

That there's some corner.....

12th General_English_Unit_1_B_Poem.indd 22 07-12-2021 17:53:15